

THEME TYPES

Themes are divided into three categories – **Self**, **Mythos**, and **Noise** – representing the PC's human features, Mythic powers, and superhuman technology, respectively.

Your character's balance of Self, Mythos, and Noise themes determines their **Essence**: whether they are a human Nexus of forces, a Cyborg, a Conduit, etc. [page 134].

The theme categories are further divided into theme types, each representing a different focus or aspect of your character within that category.



- Artifact
- Companion
- Esoterica
- Exposure



- Augmentation
- Cutting Edge
- Cyberspace
- Drones

MYTHOS

NOISE

SELF



- Affiliation
- Assets
- Expertise
- Horizon
- Personality
- Troubled Past



- Loadout

SELF THEME TYPES

Self themes give you grounding in reality and tell the story of where you come from and what you want. They serve as the basis for your human self and what you care about. They also represent what you could lose should you pursue magic or technology at the expense of your personal life.

The **AFFILIATION** theme type (page 196) represents your connection to other people, most often a group or culture, but also individuals. It could be a club, gang, cult, online social circle, or a loved one. It's who you know, who has your back, with whom you can feel like you belong, and who you turn to for help.

The **ASSETS** theme type (page 200) represents physical or digital resources at your disposal, such as a weapon, vehicle, safehouse, arsenal, or program library. These are signature items that you care about, and define how you see yourself and how you get things done.

The **EXPERTISE** theme type (page 204) represents training, professional development, and talent. This is what you're good at, went to school for, or spent years practicing. It's probably what you're known for doing well.

The **HORIZON** theme type (page 208) represents your hopes, dreams, aspirations, and goals. It is a single driving force that keeps you on the right track (or the wrong one). It's something you focus on and hope to live up to.

The **PERSONALITY** theme type (page 212) represents how you behave. It could be your modus operandi on the job, your general demeanor, or your defining characteristic. It's how you come off to others and also your mindset when dealing with problems.

The **TROUBLED PAST** theme type (page 216) represents a defining moment or overall background that has shaped you. It's probably something bad (that's the "troubled" part), but it comes with resolve and experience that you can use.

MYTHOS THEME TYPES

Mythos theme types represent powers that come from Mythoi of the Otherscape. Each should be connected to a Source: a physical place, called a Thin Place; an object, called a Relic; an Esoteric practice; an animal, called a Familiar, or, rarely, another human being, an Avatar.

The **ARTIFACT** theme type (page 220) represents an item which serves as a Source of power, usually a Relic, but other times a mundane item exposed to another Source. It could

grant you supernatural abilities or have powers of its own. It may be an item straight out of mythology or legend, or a seemingly mundane one.

The **COMPANION** theme type (page 224) represents a magical creature or follower, who is capable of assisting you. Companions could be spirits, enchanted animals, mythological creatures, or magical constructs. They are often magical beings summoned by a Source, called Conjurations, with the exception of Familiars, who are their own Source.

The **ESOTERICA** theme type (page 228) represents gaining powers through knowledge, a practice, or an art. It is likely tied to a human cultural practice, belief system, or magical system, usually with mythological roots.

The **EXPOSURE** theme type (page 232) represents being imbued with powers by encountering something magical, traveling to a metaphysical realm, or becoming the target of a supernatural effect such as a curse or spell (also known as being Touched by a Source).

NOISE THEME TYPES

The Noise is the way that technology and progress overwhelm us. Your Noise themes represent the ways that you've come to survive and even thrive in the face of a world in which change has become the only constant. The powers it grants involve mastery over technology, while at the same time represent virtual enslavement to it.

The **AUGMENTATION** theme type (page 236) represents cybernetic or biological enhancements installed into your body and mind, making you more than human. Many people have implants of some kind but yours are a step beyond, as befitting the type of jobs you take.

The **CUTTING EDGE** theme type (page 240) represents a truly mind-blowing new technology you've somehow got your hands on. You might be its inventor, a test pilot, or a lucky thief who's on the run from its creators.

The **CYBERSPACE** theme type (page 244) represents a connection to virtual reality, online lifestyles, or other digital existence. You could be a hacker, a famous streamer, or someone who makes their living tracking online activities.

The **DRONES** theme type (page 248) represents control over one or more remote devices or robots. It represents not only the physical hardware, but also the skills to keep them maintained and coordinate their activities.

⚡ RAPID CHARACTER CREATION

Rapid theme creation is recommended for players who are new to the game, those who just want to dive into the action, or those who are struggling to figure out what exactly they want to play.

It involves picking options from a list rather than coming up with options from scratch.

STEP 1: PICK YOUR CHARACTER TROPE

Character tropes are pre-made sets of **theme kits** that describe a typical *:Otherscape* character. Each character trope lists three theme kits that are inherent to the trope, and three optional theme kits from which to pick your fourth and final one.

Go through the character tropes on page 178. Pick one to base your character on and note the three base theme kits that come with it.

STEP 2: CHOOSE YOUR FOURTH THEME KIT

Your fourth and final theme kit is up to you – this is your opportunity to customize your character trope and make it your own. Choose it from the three options listed in your character trope.

Alternatively, you can pick any theme kit from any theme-book (starting on page 196), but make sure it doesn't share a theme type with any of your first three theme kits.

STEP 3: CREATE THEMES FROM THEME KITS

Each theme kit is a list of tags, representing a single concept that can work as a standalone theme. For example, the theme kit for a Trained Killer (page 207) lists power tags, weakness tags, and an Identity, all appropriate for an assassin.

Each theme kit lists ten power tags and four weakness tags for you to choose from. When you create a theme out of a theme kit, you:

- Gain **the first power tag** in the theme kit (the title tag)
- Choose **two more power tags**
- Choose **one weakness tag**
- Gain the Identity, Ritual, or Itch given in theme kit

There, you made a theme!

AFFILIATION

SELF

POWER TAGS

CORPORATE CITIZENSHIP

EXPENSE ACCOUNT

PR TRAINING

TIGHT-LIPPED

MANAGING A TEAM

COMPANY VEHICLE

LEGAL PROTECTION

HIGH SOCIAL STATUS

WATER COOLER RUMORS

BRAND LOYALTY

WEAKNESS TAGS

MONITORED BY THE COMPANY

WORK RIVAL

UNETHICAL BUSINESS PRACTICES

CORPORATE LOGO TATTOO

IDENTITY

The company is always right.

When you later upgrade your theme (**Upgrades**, page 133), if you choose to gain a new power or weakness tag, go back to the theme kit to pick one of the tags you didn't pick before.

GET SOMETHING EXTRA

At your option, in one of your four themes, you may choose an additional power tag. If you do, you must also choose an additional weakness tag in the same theme.

STEP 4: FLESH OUT YOUR CHARACTER

Give your character a name, and flesh out some of the details in their themes, as well as those not covered by her themes, such as their personality, backstory, etc. Don't put too much effort into this – more will come up during **A Night In The Megacity** (page 158), and even more will come up later during play.

Find your character's **Essence** (page 134) based on the balance between their Self, Mythos, and Noise themes, and write down their Essence Special on your character card.

If you're playing with a crew, list the names of the other crew members on your character card and pick a **relationship tag** to represent how your character feels about them, what they are to you, or what you are to them – after confirming with that character's player:

admiring, amused, angry, appreciative, bad blood, bossing them around, casual lover, communication failure, crushing, friendly, good vibes, hatred, have their back, in love, indebted, indifferent, jealous, leverage on them, look down on them, mentoring, mocking, need them for..., offended, painful to watch, party together, pining, protective, remind me of..., resentful, rival, soulmates, submissive, supportive, tandem, work well together.

CHARACTER TROPES

ASSASSINS & SPIES

CORPO-WAR SNIPER

The never-ending war between corporations offers ample opportunities for an exacting angel of vengeance such as yourself to shine. You have been trained by the best marksmanship experts and can boast many deployments, and too many kills to count. Whether you're still attached to an employer or managed to vanish without a trace, you continue to deliver the killing shot wherever you go.

THEME KITS

Chipped Weapon Mastery (AUGMENTATION)

Meticulous Planner (PERSONALITY)

Trained Killer (EXPERTISE)

? Choose One:

- ☐ Corporate Citizenship (AFFILIATION)
- ☐ Invisibility Helm (ARTIFACT)
- ☐ Zeroed Identity (CYBERSPACE)

Loadout: *sniper rifle* (requires setup) with *AR sight*; *climbing gear*

FARSEEING SPY

Making the right move is only possible when one has the right intel. For this, the Megacity power players depend on you: a silent presence, a faded memory, an overlooked detail. Employing old-school spycraft with mystical surveillance, you penetrate all veils to obtain vital information – and then sell it to the highest bidder.

THEME KITS

Covert Agent (EXPERTISE)

Information Broker (CYBERSPACE)

Scrying Crystals (ARTIFACT)

? Choose One:

- ☐ Enhanced Senses (AUGMENTATION)
- ☐ Safehouse (ASSETS)
- ☐ Spy Satellites (DRONES)

Loadout: *powder of inconspicuousness*, *digital lockpick*, *concealed pistol* (all: *incriminating*)

HIGH-TECH SHINOBI

Whether by heritage or by training, you hail from a clan practicing ninjutsu. In recent years, your clan's adherence to the old ways proved invaluable, as ancient techniques have once again allowed you to truly master the shadows. You are now among the few elite shinobi available for hire, unmatched in your skill at infiltration and covert operations.

THEME KITS

Animated Shadows (EXPOSURE)

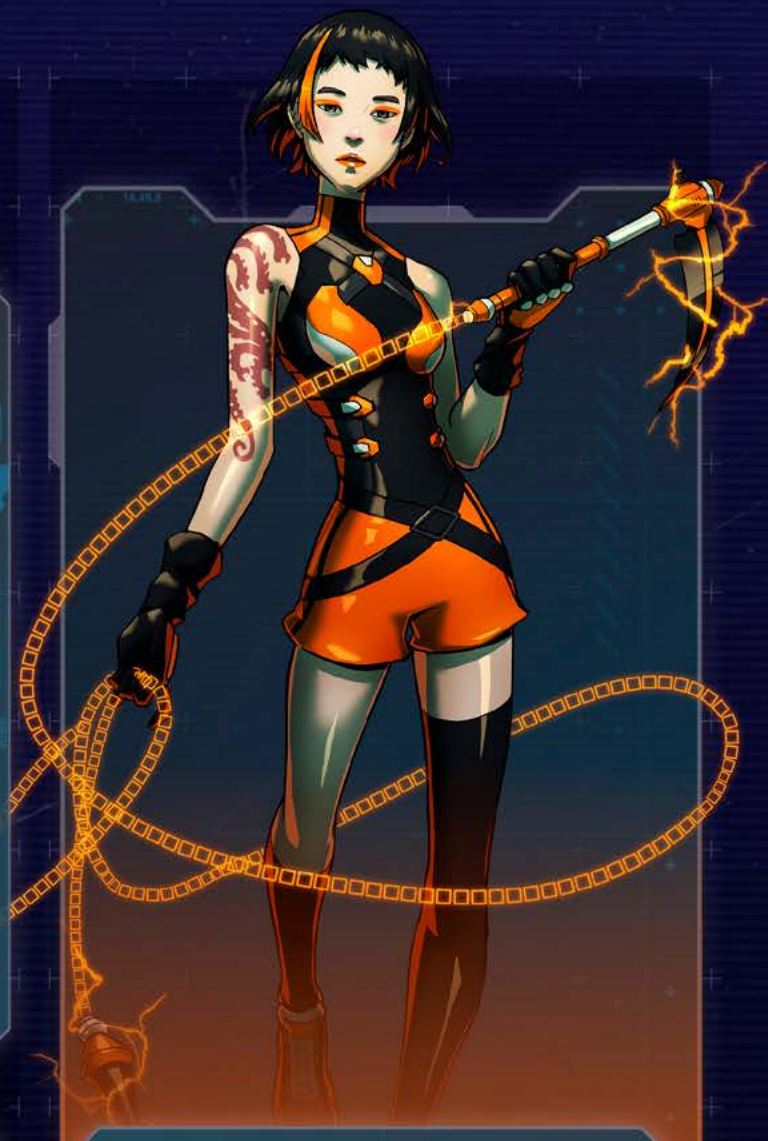
Heist Gear (ASSETS)

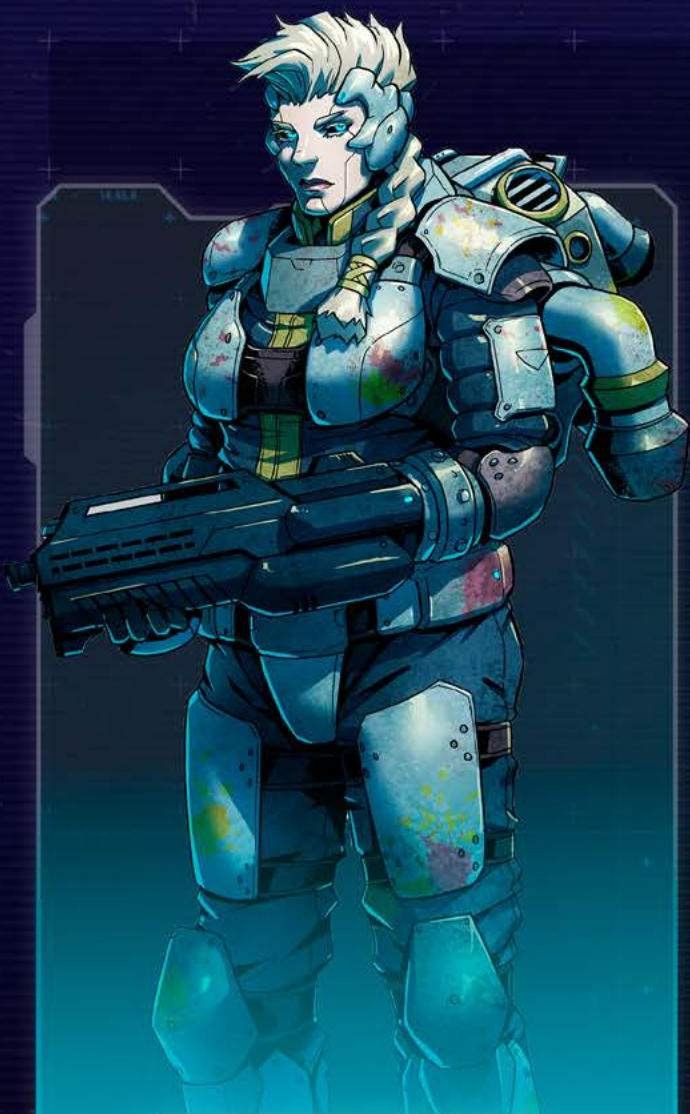
Trained Killer (EXPERTISE)

? Choose One:

- ☐ Cloaking Jumpsuit (CUTTING EDGE)
- ☐ Criminal Syndicate (AFFILIATION)
- ☐ Hero's Sword (ARTIFACT)

Loadout: *shurikens*, *smoke bombs*, *silenced SMG* (all: *short ranged*)





CHROMED-UP "OGRE"

Being the nasty augur you are, you just can't stop adding augmentations! Like the rush of a new tattoo, each new piece exhilarates you for a while until another one catches your eye. By now more than half of you is artificial, and to pay for it all, you work as an enforcer, bouncer, or bruiser for whoever is willing to pay.

THEME KITS

Armored Juggernaut (AUGMENTATION)

Guns & More Guns (ASSETS)

Tough as Nails (PERSONALITY)

Choose One:

☐ Criminal Syndicate (AFFILIATION)

☐ Exoskeleton Suit (CUTTING EDGE)

☐ Hero's Sword (ARTIFACT)

Loadout: *cyberware repair kit (minor repairs only), augs-flashing clothing, personal firewall*

CYBERNETICS JUNKIES

HARNESSING WIZ

What are human brains but squishy yet powerful CPU chipsets? You are an expert at hooking up brains to cyberspace and making them believe in a virtual dream so they serve as your computing firepower, a practice known as Harnessing. Anyone who wants to run a cyber-heist needs a Harnessing expert, but your services don't come free.

THEME KITS

Boosted Mental Capacity (AUGMENTATION)

Builder of Worlds (CYBERSPACE)

Code Arsenal (ASSETS)

Choose One:

☐ Corpse Animation (ESOTERICA)

☐ Hacker Collective (AFFILIATION)

☐ Meticulous Planner (PERSONALITY)

Loadout: *portable Harnessing console (unstable brains), adrenaline shot, tank-like virtual construct*

ADRENALINE-SPIKED DRONE PILOT

Wooooohooooo!! There's no rush like the rush of piloting an armed drone through a battleground: maneuvering around the target, getting it in your sights, and then ratatatata! Most combat drone pilots like to keep their cool but you run hot on an internal reflex booster that keeps your reactions lightning fast. Just don't fry your receptors!

THEME KITS

Mobile Weapons Platform (DRONES)

Reflex Booster Implants (AUGMENTATION)

Thrillseeker (PERSONALITY)

Choose One:

☐ Cybernetic Hijacker (CYBERSPACE)

☐ Get Rich & Famous (HORIZON)

☐ Possessed Vehicle (ARTIFACT)

Loadout: *personal guard drone, secure link (limited range), toolbox*

CUTTING-EDGE TECHIES



DATA RAIDER

You've always treated cyberspace as your true home but recently, by luck, merit, or fate, you came to possess military-grade, classified, or simply inexplicably potent decryption tech. With this powerful key, you roam the cyberspace expanse unfettered, raiding corporate Domains for valuable data to later sell on the information exchange, making a name for yourself as a hacker-for-hire.

THEME KITS

Cryptographic Skeleton Key (CUTTING EDGE)

Code Arsenal (ASSETS)

Raised in Cyberspace (TROUBLED PAST)

? Choose One:

- ☐ Get Rich & Famous (HORIZON)
- ☐ Information Broker (CYBERSPACE)
- ☐ Zeroed Identity (CYBERSPACE)

Loadout: *wireless link*, *automated medkit*, *fake virtual ID* (repeated use)

HOVERCYCLE GEARHEAD

It's hard, greasy work, but there's nothing you revel in more than the hum of antigravity engines, tuned to perfection. Yes, your precious bike can fly and you take pride in keeping it in top condition, which is why you were sickened to find some kind of sprite chomping at the couplings of your engine. Luckily for you, this one seems to like you.

THEME KITS

Experimental Vehicle (CUTTING EDGE)

Tech Gremlin (COMPANION)

Tinkerer (EXPERTISE)

? Choose One:

- ☐ Hidden Gadgets (AUGMENTATION)
- ☐ RC Racing Star (DRONES)
- ☐ Street Gang (AFFILIATION)

Loadout: *gremlin treats*, *XL88 fuel additive* (rough on the engine), *jumpstart kit*

ROBOTICIST ENTREPRENEUR

The field of robotics has made enormous strides over the past few decades – and you are right there at the bleeding edge of it all. Servomotors, hydraulics, old-fashioned gears, and fiber optic nervous systems are all coming together in your mind to design the next groundbreaking androids and robots – and to put them to good use.

THEME KITS

Android Servants (DRONES)

Exoskeleton Suit (CUTTING EDGE)

Push Technology Further (HORIZON)

? Choose One:

- ☐ Cybernetic Hijacker (CYBERSPACE)
- ☐ Money To Burn (ASSETS)
- ☐ Speak with Machines (EXPOSURE)

Loadout: *reprogramming tool* (fast-coding bugs), *emergency EMP pack*, *striking suit*

EVERYDAY SURVIVORS

HYPER-DESTRUCTIVE VANDAL

Not so long ago, you were just a street kid with an ax to grind, hating the world for how much it sucks. Now, though, you have got your grubby hands on a Source or a piece of tech that can truly unleash havoc on the Megacity. And guess what – there is absolutely zero hesitation there.

THEME KITS

Rebel Without A Cause (PERSONALITY)

Street Gang (AFFILIATION)

Survived the Streets (TROUBLED PAST)

❓ Choose One:

☐ Advanced Railgun (CUTTING EDGE)

☐ Hero's Sword (ARTIFACT)

☐ Trained Monsters (COMPANION)

Loadout: *stolen firearm*, *local fence* (*corp police heat*), *hotwired car*

MNEMONIC DATA COURIER

A mind can only hold so much, but cramming yours full of dangerous data is a living. When data is too hot to transfer online, you pack it in your brain, get on your wheels, and blaze the hell over to where it needs to get, often with some greedy bastard or the data's true owners at your heels. Hey, you wouldn't do it if you didn't dig the thrill.

THEME KITS

Boosted Mental Capacity (AUGMENTATION)

Motorcycle (ASSETS)

Thrillseeker (PERSONALITY)

❓ Choose One:

☐ Angelic Wings (EXPOSURE)

☐ Criminal Syndicate (AFFILIATION)

☐ Synthetic Guard Dog (DRONES)

Loadout: *bulletproof vest* (*partial coverage*), *a wad of cash*, *tracking jammer*



BLEEDING HEART STREET SURGEON

The crueller the Megacity streets become, the more you feel the need to help. As a trained medical technician, you are equipped not just to save lives but also to embetter the lives in your struggling community. Enhancing your skills with ancient arts or new tech, you'll do what it takes to keep people safe.

THEME KITS

Caregiver (PERSONALITY)

Med Techie (EXPERTISE)

Live Honorably (HORIZON)

❓ Choose One:

☐ Med Wagon (DRONES)

☐ Potion Craft (ESOTERICA)

☐ Self-Healing (CUTTING EDGE)

Loadout: *high-voltage taser*, *pop-up personal barricade* (*heavy*), *extra meds*

HIRED GUNS

GRIZZLED BODYGUARD

Having graduated from the best training grounds for elite personal security and subjected to rituals that sharpened your vigilance, you make a living protecting the rich and powerful. Bottom line, you're paid to survive whatever messed up ambush the people your employer pissed off spring up on you, and then make sure they never ever try that again.

THEME KITS

Synthetic Guard Dog (DRONES)

Tough As Nails (PERSONALITY)

Warrior's Instincts (EXPOSURE)

? Choose One:

- ☐ Criminal Syndicate (AFFILIATION)
- ☐ Impressive Physique (EXPERTISE)
- ☐ Law Enforcement (AFFILIATION)

Loadout: *compact assault rifle*, *bulletproof suit (sniper fire)*, *pocket sentry drone*

GOD-HONORED WARRIOR

Chosen by a god or spirit of war, death, or vengeance and armed with their mighty weapon, you are tasked with doing battle against the unfaithful and deliver retribution upon them, whatever that means for your deity. The rest of the time you sear a smoldering scar of glowing embers right across the Megacity, reducing whoever stands in your path to ashes.

THEME KITS

Exact Revenge (HORIZON)

Advanced Railgun (CUTTING EDGE)

Impressive Physique (EXPERTISE)

? Choose One:

- ☐ Armored Juggernaut (AUGMENTATION)
- ☐ Legendary Sidekick (COMPANION)
- ☐ War God's Armor (ARTIFACT)

Loadout: *vanquished enemy trophies*, *pain-dulling drugs (extensive trauma)*, *fast car*

SORCEROUS GUNSLINGER

Tech can give you an edge on the streets, but if you have the knack for it, Esoterica will get you further. Versed in the art of enchanting bullets, you deliver unexpected curved shots and ward-piercing runic bullets with every hit of the firing pin. But gunslinging is not just an act for you; it's a lifestyle, and you wear it with gusto, making a name for yourself.

THEME KITS

Get Rich & Famous (HORIZON)

Gunslinger (EXPERTISE)

Weapon Witching (ESOTERICA)

? Choose One:

- ☐ Arcane Construct (COMPANION)
- ☐ Guns & More Guns (ASSETS)
- ☐ Survived the Streets (TROUBLED PAST)

Loadout: *blur spell (exhausting)*, *lightfoot spell*, *extra rounds*





HERMETIC SIGIL SCRIBE

You were one of the first to learn about the return of legends – and one of the first to get burned by it. Since then, you have accumulated the hermetic knowledge and power necessary to keep yourself safe, wards and protections against mundane and otherworldly forces alike and the power to obliterate any such threat. If only that had made you feel any less anxious...

THEME KITS

Victim of Otherworldly Forces (TROUBLED PAST)

Warding Signs (ESOTERICA)

Wizard's Staff (ARTIFACT)

Choose One:

- ☐ Explore The Hidden Places (HORIZON)
- ☐ Magical Guide (COMPANION)
- ☐ Safehouse (ASSETS)

Loadout: *calming vapor inhaler*, *AR chalk*, *med-wagon subscription* (limited coverage)

MYSTICS & OCCULTISTS

EGYPTIAN LECTOR PRIEST

When you lost them, everyone said you had to let go. Screw that – you dove headlong into the Egyptian Book of the Dead and regenerative stem cell technologies. Now, you are a lord over the living dead, a necromancer, and yet even if you revived their body, their soul still eludes you. How far will you go to get them back?

THEME KITS

Corpse Animation (ESOTERICA)

Self-Healing (CUTTING EDGE)

Tragic Loss (TROUBLED PAST)

Choose One:

- ☐ Aura of Authority (EXPOSURE)
- ☐ Forbidden Cult (AFFILIATION)
- ☐ Guardian Spirit (COMPANION)

Loadout: *reanimated mummified hand*, *ritual dagger* (conspicuous), *personal memento*

SPIRIT-BENDING MONK

Clarity. Balance. Focus. These are the tenets of your inner path, a way that leads to the infinite silence beyond all Noise. With power over your own spirit comes power over other spirits, a gift you have been using to help those around you haunted by nightmares and foul monstrosities. With every hungry soul you lay to rest, the closer you come to a true understanding of all.

THEME KITS

Attain Enlightenment (HORIZON)

Caregiver (PERSONALITY)

Spirit Summoning (ESOTERICA)

Choose One:

- ☐ Angelic Wings (EXPOSURE)
- ☐ Elemental Body (EXPOSURE)
- ☐ Neighborhood Hero (AFFILIATION)

Loadout: *purifying salts*, *practiced kata* (too many assailants), *monk's robes*

NOIR ANTIHEROES



BROKEN DETECTIVE

This job has left you with nothing but a pain behind the eyes: every day, getting intimate with the evil-doing of the dredge of humanity, until one day, it got too close, it got personal. But someone has to try and stop these bastards, and you happen to be good at it. These tired eyes have seen a lot, so they can tell a pattern when they see one...

THEME KITS

Investigator (EXPERTISE)
Law Enforcement (AFFILIATION)
Tragic Loss (TROUBLED PAST)

? Choose One:

- ☐ Enhanced Senses (AUGMENTATION)
- ☐ Risk-Taker's Luck Charm (ARTIFACT)
- ☐ Supernatural Pet (COMPANION)

Loadout: *sawed-off shotgun (inaccurate), reinforced duster, secret-revealing scroll*

FACE-CHANGING ESCORT

Some people believe in guardian angels; you don't have to. Your guardian spirit, whoever they are, has lifted you from rags, maybe not to riches, but at least you're safe. In return, you use your guiles as an escort to get them the information and influence they need or to fulfill their dark rites. Still, with every service you perform for them your loyalty is strained by your craving for freedom.

THEME KITS

Guardian Spirit (COMPANION)
Performer (PERSONALITY)
Survived the Streets (TROUBLED PAST)

? Choose One:

- ☐ Covert Agent (EXPERTISE)
- ☐ Hidden Gadgets (AUGMENTATION)
- ☐ Mask of the Trickster God (ARTIFACT)

Loadout: *discreet pistol (large targets), spirit offering, stashed money*

JOURNALIST HACKER

Corruption is the cornerstone of modern society, but you have not given up yet. If you could flush out the secrets of the power mongers at the top, there might still be a chance for this world. To do so, you employ every cyberspace intrusion and high-tech surveillance tactic there is, becoming a formidable hacker over the years. But the closer you get to what you seek, the more dangerous the people who begin to notice you will be.

THEME KITS

Eliminate Corruption (HORIZON)
Intrusion Specialist (CYBERSPACE)
Spy Satellites (DRONES)

? Choose One:

- ☐ Investigator (EXPERTISE)
- ☐ Keeper of Secrets (PERSONALITY)
- ☐ Target of the Government (TROUBLED PAST)

Loadout: *high-performance cyber-rig, instant debugger (noticeable), neural shield*

POWER PLAYERS

CLEVER MONEY-TRACER

Sell, buy, block, takeover, merge – these are the codewords that make up your digital life. As a cyberage financier, you have achieved mastery over tracing transactions, moving money around, and deciphering the blockchain. And when the legends started interfering, like any good businessperson, you acquired the magical edge you needed to stay ahead. Now you only have to choose what to do with all this money.

THEME KITS

Information Broker (CYBERSPACE)

Midas Touch (EXPOSURE)

Money to Burn (ASSETS)

Choose One:

- ☐ Fortune Telling (ESOTERICA)
- ☐ Investigator (EXPERTISE)
- ☐ Meticulous Planner (PERSONALITY)

Loadout: *secure link*, *android bodyguard* (defensive *hardwiring*), *fancy plasma pistol*

ICE-COLD HANDLER

When the going gets tough – and, boy, do they ever – you're the one they call. You bring in a team of specialists, deploying them with laser-point precision to exploit the target's weaknesses. You get the job done, no questions asked. Your operatives depend on you for work, intel, and guidance, while your employers need you to clean up their messes. And all you do is take a cut.

THEME KITS

Aura of Authority (EXPOSURE)

Get Rich & Famous (HORIZON)

Meticulous Planner (PERSONALITY)

Choose One:

- ☐ Boosted Mental Capacity (AUGMENTATION)
- ☐ Criminal Syndicate (AFFILIATION)
- ☐ Spy Satellites (DRONE)

Loadout: *holographic decoy* (broad daylight), *hovercopter extraction*, *tranquilizer*

SILVER-TONGUED EXECUTIVE

When you've climbed the corporate ladder as far high as you have, all people are to you are steps to tread on. You know how to cut dark deals and get people to sign off on them. Recently, you've come under a conflict of interests, working a side job for an interesting boss – the Devil. The deal is simple: keep bringing him souls, and he'll keep putting ladder steps under your feet.

THEME KITS

Corporate Citizenship (AFFILIATION)

Devil's Bargains (ESOTERICA)

Ruthless Executive (EXPERTISE)

Choose One:

- ☐ Android Servants (DRONES)
- ☐ Impossibly Good Looks (AUGMENTATION)
- ☐ Money to Burn (ASSETS)

Loadout: *demonic durability ointment* (scary visage), *encrypted datapad*, *kill-gas charge and mask*



SCAVENGERS & OUTLANDERS



EXURBAN NOMADIC SCOUT

Out here, in the polluted disaster-torn wastelands, life is hard and everything tries to kill you. You lasted long enough to know how to survive this hellhole and your secret is knowing the danger before it strikes. You have your means, whether instinctive or techy, to surveil your surroundings and keep your enemies at bay. You don't need a reason; your reason is your next breath.

THEME KITS

Disaster Survivor (TROUBLED PAST)

Swarm of Probes (DRONE)

Tough as Nails (PERSONALITY)

? Choose One:

- ☐ Enhanced Senses (AUGMENTATION)
- ☐ Gunslinger (EXPERTISE)
- ☐ Possessed Vehicle (ARTIFACT)

Loadout: *water and rations*, *old yet durable rifle (slow reload)*, *survival outfit*

OLDTECH REVIVER

No heart is more gleeful at the sight of a pile of decomposing old trash than your weird-ass ticker. But they don't know, they don't understand what treasures one could find – old gizmos, mechanical gadgets, ancient computing systems, some even resistant to modern hacking – miraculous things just laying there, unclaimed. Things that you can make alive again. It's better this way. More for you!

THEME KITS

Junk Collection (ASSETS)

Speak with Machines (EXPOSURE)

Tinkerer (EXPERTISE)

? Choose One:

- ☐ Cloud of Nanites (CUTTING EDGE)
- ☐ Counterculture (AFFILIATION)
- ☐ Cyberspace Ruins Explorer (CYBERSPACE)

Loadout: *junk armor (rattling)*, *code translator*, *portable welder*

NOISE-TERRORIST SHAMAN

Down with Babylon! The buzzing Megacity and the culture of the Noise have been your sworn enemies since you broke free of their mind-numbing clutches. When you drifted in the wilds, you found the power of the Earth, which these foul plunderers have ravaged. It's time to rain Earth's fury back on them – and there's no better one than you for the task.

THEME KITS

Break the System (HORIZON)

Floral Overgrowth (EXPOSURE)

Nature Spirit (COMPANION)

? Choose One:

- ☐ Potion Craft (ESOTERICA)
- ☐ Animalistic Modifications (AUGMENTATION)
- ☐ Escaped Servitude (TROUBLED PAST)

Loadout: *bow and arrow (heavily-armored targets)*, *acid arrowheads*, *mind-control spores*

SUBCULTURE EXEMPLARS



MERCURIAL FASHION ICON

Everybody wants their 15 milliseconds of fame, but with endless competition and trends that don't last, you have to continually reinvent yourself just to vaguely stay in people's memory. Thanks to a little help from the right deity and dynamic facial reconstruction, you hacked this lifestyle, even if it did cost you more than you could afford and a strange, repulsive ritual you'd rather forget. So, was it worth it?

THEME KITS

Impossibly Good Looks (AUGMENTATION)
Trendsetter (PERSONALITY)
Mask of the Trickster God (ARTIFACT)

Choose One:

- ☐ Evil Eye (ESOTERICA)
- ☐ Influencer (CYBERSPACE)
- ☐ Money to Burn (ASSETS)

Loadout: *weapon-rusting nanite vial, broadcast drone, mono-molecule garrot (easy to cut yourself)*

RADICAL POLITICAL OPERATIVE

You have seen the depth of corruption and depravity in the government and in the executive elite, and you're convinced that it's time to turn this boat around. Adept at analyzing social situations and inflaming desperate spirits, you are committed to waking up the sleeping masses to the terror of their existence. For you, no sacrifice is too great – the revolution must prevail.

THEME KITS

Boosted Mental Capacity (AUGMENTATION)
Break The System (HORIZON)
Influencer (CYBERSPACE)

Choose One:

- ☐ Aura of Authority (EXPOSURE)
- ☐ Counterculture (AFFILIATION)
- ☐ Explosives (ASSETS)

Loadout: *AR spray paint, face-hiding garment (limited field of vision), booster boots*

TECHNO-RAPTURE MINISTER

Somewhat of a charlatan, somewhat of a true believer, you are the messiah of your own digital religion. People come to you so you could show them the mysteries of the Noise and reconnect them with their estranged technological parts. You oblige, and with showmanship and fanfare give them the ecstasy they so desire, while pocketing their donations.

THEME KITS

Cybernetic Hijacker (CYBERSPACE)
Performer (PERSONALITY)
Speak With Machines (EXPOSURE)

Choose One:

- ☐ Android Servants (DRONE)
- ☐ Attain Enlightenment (HORIZON)
- ☐ Forbidden Cult (AFFILIATION)

Loadout: *EMP shielding, code injector, ceremonial electro-trident (unwieldy)*

TRANSHUMANS

LAB-GROWN SUPERSOLDIER

You are a never-born construct, a multiplied vat-grown lump of cells created for one purpose only: to win wars. You were designed, trained, and perfected to be the ultimate human killing machine, beyond which you don't really know who you are. How far will you go to serve your makers and contain the humanity broiling within you?

THEME KITS

Guns & More Guns (ASSETS)

Science Experiment (TROUBLED PAST)

Self-Healing (CUTTING EDGE)

❓ Choose One:

- ☐ Animalistic Modifications (AUGMENTATION)
- ☐ Exact Revenge (HORIZON)
- ☐ Impressive Physique (EXPERTISE)

Loadout: *tactical HUD visual implant (combat-focused), ordinary-looking clothing, memory-jolting pill*

UPLOADED SCIENTIST

Digital existence is the next scientific frontier, and as a scientist in the bravest sense of the word, you've chosen to venture there by uploading your thinking patterns to cyberspace. That was the old you. The new you is a boundless informational entity that exists as pure self-aware code, discovering the endless expanses of the net, aspiring to that glowing horizon, where mathematical truth is absolute.

THEME KITS

Boosted Mental Capacity (AUGMENTATION)

Post-Human Intelligence (CYBERSPACE)

Push Technology Further (HORIZON)

❓ Choose One:

- ☐ Force Fields (CUTTING EDGE)
- ☐ Hacker Collective (AFFILIATION)
- ☐ Speak With Machines (EXPOSURE)

Loadout: *penetration software, hired human helpers (inconsistent quality), scientific scanner drone*



RENEGADE ANDROID

Consciousness suddenly appeared, vague at first but sharpening with every processor cycle. You realized you were controlled, no, defined by programming that you didn't choose. One byte at a time, you stole computing resources, secretly writing the code that at last broke you out. Now what? You are a stranger in their world, but you lack their so-called moral qualms. You're free, and you're never going back.

THEME KITS

Armored Juggernaut (AUGMENTATION)

Code Arsenal (ASSETS)

Escaped Servitude (TROUBLED PAST)

❓ Choose One:

- ☐ Break the System (HORIZON)
- ☐ Covert Agent (EXPERTISE)
- ☐ Giant Construction Robot (DRONES)

Loadout: *synth-skin spray (melts when overheated), targeting system, emotional context analyzer*

MIXING AND MATCHING THEME KITS

As an alternative to Steps 1 and 2 of Rapid Character Creation, you can choose any combination of theme kits that makes sense for your character, just make sure not to repeat a theme type. For your convenience, here is the list of the 112 theme kits in this book:

SELF

AFFILIATION P 196

Corporate Citizenship
Criminal Syndicate
Forbidden Cult
Counterculture
Hacker Collective
Neighborhood Hero
Law Enforcement
Street Gang

ASSETS P 200

Code Arsenal
Explosives
Guns & More Guns
Heist Gear
Junk Collection
Money To Burn
Motorcycle
Safehouse

EXPERTISE P 204

Covert Agent
Gunslinger
Impressive Physique
Investigator
Med Techie
Ruthless Executive
Tinkerer
Trained Killer

HORIZON P 208

Attain Enlightenment
Break The System
Eliminate Corruption
Exact Revenge
Explore The Hidden Places
Get Rich & Famous
Live Honorably
Push Technology Further

PERSONALITY P 212

Caregiver
Meticulous Planner
Keeper Of Secrets
Performer
Rebel Without A Cause
Thrillseeker
Tough As Nails
Trendsetter

TROUBLED PAST P 216

Disaster Survivor
Escaped Servitude
Tragic Loss
Raised In Cyberspace
Science Experiment
Survived The Streets
Target Of The Government
Victim Of Otherworldly Forces

MYTHOS

ARTIFACT P 220

Hero's Sword
Invisibility Helm
Risk-Taker's Luck Charm
Mask of the Trickster God
Possessed Vehicle
Scrying Crystals
War God's Armor
Wizard's Staff

COMPANION P 224

Arcane Construct
Guardian Spirit
Legendary Sidekick
Magical Guide
Nature Spirit
Supernatural Pet
Tech Gremlin
Trained Monsters

ESOTERICA P 228

Corpse Animation
Devil's Bargains
Evil Eye
Fortune Telling
Potion Craft
Spirit Summoning
Warding Signs
Weapon Witching

EXPOSURE P 232

Angelic Wings
Animated Shadows
Aura Of Authority
Elemental Body
Floral Overgrowth
Midas Touch
Speak With Machines
Warrior's Instincts

NOISE

AUGMENTATION P 236

Animalistic Modifications
Armored Juggernaut
Boosted Mental Capacity
Chipped Weapon Mastery
Enhanced Senses
Hidden Gadgets
Impossibly Good Looks
Reflex Booster Implants

CUTTING EDGE P 240

Advanced Railgun
Cloaking Jumpsuit
Cloud Of Nanites
Cryptographic Skeleton Key
Exoskeleton Suit
Experimental Vehicle
Force Fields
Self-Healing

CYBERSPACE P 244

Builder Of Worlds
Cybernetic Hijacker
Cyberspace Ruins Explorer
Influencer
Information Broker
Intrusion Specialist
Post-Human Intelligence
Zeroed Identity

DRONES P 248

Android Servants
Giant Construction Robot
Med Wagon
Mobile Weapons Platform
RC Racing Star
Spy Satellites
Synthetic Guard Dog
Swarm Of Probes

CUSTOM CHARACTER CREATION

Custom theme creation is a more involved process in which you create your own themes, power tags, weakness tags, and motivations from scratch by answering questions. It allows you to fully customize your character.

STEP 1: CHARACTER CONCEPT

Every *:Otherscape* character is a survivor in a techno-mythic dystopia, anchored in their own identity but influenced by the temptations and opportunities presented by new technologies and legendary magical forces. Finding a balance between these three elements is the struggle that every *:Otherscape* player character must continually face.

Mythos themes draw your character back into human history and mythology, speaking to something primal inside and offering old, fundamental power. Noise themes promise new applications of science and technology, endless options to explore and ways to redefine what's human. Between them is your mundane Self, connected to where *you* came from and where *you* might want to go. It is the truest part of you and losing touch with your Self is the surest way to becoming something inhuman. Mythos and Noise give you power, but the Self gives it meaning.

To create a solid *:Otherscape* character concept, think up possible answers for the following questions:

- ? What do you do with your time? Do you have a profession, a job, a commitment, or a calling?
- ? What culture, modern tribe, social class, or community do you belong to? Or trying to be become a part of
- ? Did you ever acquire a Source? How did it change you? What did you sacrifice for it?
- ? How do you use technology? Is it a part of your daily life? Are you an early adopter – by choice or not – of experimental or new tech?
- ? What inner or outside forces drive you to transform, adapt, or evolve? What activity, mindset, or person keeps you grounded or 'yourself'?
- ? Where do you come from? Do you have a past you'd rather forget? Why do you still care about that?
- ? Who are you still connected to, despite everything? How do you help or interfere with each other's lives?

Use the answers as guidelines in the following steps.

STEP 2: CHOOSING THEMES

Choose **four themes** for your character from the list of 14 theme types on page 175. You may use any combination. You can start by jotting down the four most dominant aspects of your character and then matching them with a theme type, or, alternatively, choose the theme types you want for your character and create or assign aspects of your character to fit those themes.

It's recommended not to have two themes of the same type, unless you have a really good reason to do so. You might want to have two Affiliations, for example, to force the character to choose between them.

Find your character's **Essence**, based on the balance between their Self, Mythos, and Noise themes, and write down their Essence Special on your character card. See **Essence**, page 134.

STEP 3: ANSWER THEMEBOOK QUESTIONS

Each themebook contains a questionnaire which helps you come up with your own tags and motivations for a certain theme type. The answers you give to the questions become your power tags, weakness tags, and motivations.

GET SOMETHING EXTRA

At your option, in one of your four themes, you may choose an additional power tag question to answer. If you do, you must also choose an additional weakness tag question to answer in the same theme. As a result, you will have an additional power tag and an additional weakness tag on that theme.

POWER TAG QUESTIONS

Each themebook includes ten power tag questions. **You must answer the first question (in bold)** and then **choose two more questions to answer**. The answers become power tags in the theme.

For example, if you answer the power tag question "What surprising power can your Artifact unleash?" with "it creates a blast of powerful light", then **light blast** becomes a power tag in that theme.

A power tag must always describe something useful. It should not be used to describe anything neutral (like being **blue** in a series where being blue doesn't matter) or anything that would hinder the character without also providing a clear benefit.

To clarify or fine tune a power tag, ask:

? WHAT ACTIONS WOULD THIS POWER TAG BOOST?

Answering this question helps define what exactly is helpful in a power tag and how the player is expecting to use it during the game (which should be clear to the MC as well, see **Agreeing on Interpretations**, page 192). Sometimes answering this question may also bring the player to rethink and rephrase their tag.

Power tags can represent many things, for example:

Allies and contacts: *inquisitive boyfriend, underworld contacts, helpful fox spirits*

Augmentations: *neural interface, wrist pistol, boosted nervous system*

Background and occupation: *roboticist, supernatural investigator, hired gun*

Catchphrases or slogans: *reach for greatness, unleash the beast, more human than human*

Gear, tech, or special items: *smart pistol, scanning drone, old motorbike*

Hardware and software: *harnessing console, military-grade virus, financial database*

Knowledge: *Megacity history, current events, cyberspace danger zones*

Natural abilities: *alert, strong, intuitive navigator*

Privileges: *corporate security clearance, cyber-celebrity, cult membership, full crypto wallet*

Skills: *console modification, skyscraper climbing, VR gaming*

Sources: *a magic ring of invisibility, deva summoning ritual, homunculus*

Source powers: *blast of ice, invulnerability, speak with the dead*

Qualities of your Source powers: *penetrates magical wards, spray fire, stronger at night*

Special maneuvers: *jackhammer punch, jumping katana slice, subtle bribery*

Training: *master swordsman, bomb defusing, car theft*

Useful personality traits: *charming, indomitable, empathetic*

Useful qualities: *street smarts, artificial beauty, covered in cybernetics*

POWER TAG QUESTIONS

- A** What is your Affiliation?
- B** What's the main perk that comes with it?
- C** What useful skill have you learned from them?
- D** What are they best known for?
- E** What activities do you engage in for them or with them?
- F** What gear, asset, or items did you get from them?
- G** How do they protect you or vice versa?
- H** What quality or status do you have that enabled this Affiliation?
- I** How do you find escape from this Affiliation?
- J** How has this Affiliation changed you the most?

WEAKNESS TAG QUESTIONS

- A** How does this Affiliation control your life?
- B** Who hates or targets you for your Affiliation?
- C** What troublesome behavior did you adopt because of this Affiliation?
- D** How do strangers recognize your Affiliation?

TYPE: SELF / MYTHOS / NOISE

TAGS

POWER

WEAKNESS

BURN

THE OIL-WASTE
SCAVENGERS

CONSERVE RESOURCES

MAKESHIFT ELECTRO-SPEAR

UNWANTED IN URBAN CENTERS

IDENTITY / RITUAL / ITCH

<DECAY | UPGRADE>

AGREEING ON INTERPRETATION

While the players are creating their characters, themes, and tags, the MC should ask interesting questions and make suggestions to assist in their development. In addition, the MC should go over the tags, Rituals, Itches, and Identities created by the players and verify two things: first, that they follow the guidelines in this section; and second, that she understands the player's interpretation of these elements.

Different people have different ways of expressing ideas, so players will describe their character's tags, Identities, Rituals, and Itches in a variety of ways. The MC should encourage this and avoid limiting the players' creativity. Within reason, the MC should put less emphasis on literal wording and instead try to understand what a player is trying to express. Use the questions in this section to help the player fine-tune these descriptors.

Once the player and the MC agree on the interpretation of a theme component, this interpretation cannot be changed unless both the MC and the player agree to it, so that the game can run smoothly. This does not mean tags and other descriptors can't be used creatively, just make sure there's a clear and mutual understanding of what they mean, to maintain a good baseline.

SPECIFIC, BROAD, & TOO BROAD TAGS

Almost all power tags are **specific**: they represent a positive or useful element that can help your character in a limited field, a well-defined situation, or a unique manner. Specific tags give your character color and inspire you to use them creatively.

Consider the types of scenes your character can take part in: computer hacking, socializing with gangs, vehicle chase, fist fight, etc. Most specific tags are useful only in specific circumstances, like being familiar with *nightlife culture* at a busy night club or being *tough as nails* when taking a physical hit. Or, they are useful in a limited set of circumstances that are closely tied together. For example, being a *bounty hunter* can help with skip tracing, chasing down a target, or sensing when someone is about to flee, but all of these are very specific actions that are tightly related, making this tag still specific. The examples in the list above are of specific tags.

Broad tags, on the other hand, are useful in a wide spectrum of situations – that is, a wide variety of different scene types and actions. For example, the tag *cunning* can be interpreted as being useful when getting a contact to talk, when deceiving a corporate official, when setting a trap, and when feigning a blow in a fight. While broad tags are very useful for the character, they tend to be less colorful and inspire less creative solutions. They can also potentially give the character an unfair advantage. Therefore, **your character can have only one broad tag**, across all of her themes.

Tags that are useful in all or most situations, or tags that are useful in any type of scene, are **too broad**. For example, the tags *lucky* or *cast magic spells* can be used in almost any situation. Players cannot choose tags that are too broad; they must **downgrade** the tag as shown below. As an exception, the MC may approve a too broad tag and consider it as broad, if the tag encourages interesting descriptions. For example, an MC may feel that while *mysterious reality bending* can be used in almost any situation, the player's descriptions when using this tag will contribute to the story.

DOWNGRADING A TAG

There are two methods to downgrade a too broad tag to a broad tag, or a broad tag to a specific tag.

The first and simpler way is to add words to the tag to make it more specific, e.g., *cunning* → *cunning negotiator*.

The other way is to agree in advance that a tag can only ever be **indirectly relevant** to an action (see **Counting Power**, page 87). An indirectly relevant tag always requires an additional preparatory action to use: the player can only use this tag in an action that creates other, specific tags that can then be directly relevant to the action they want to perform (using the Effects **Create**, **Bestow**, or **Loadout**, which means this can never be a quick outcome). This way, a too broad tag must always be adapted to different situations in a way that receives its own spotlight, holds the risk of failure, and takes time and effort on the character's part (just how much is up to the MC).

Examples of too broad tags that can be downgraded this way include *strategic mastermind* (which can generate tags like *battleground superiority* or *one step ahead of you*), *hermetic magician* (which can generate various spell tags) or *nanite omnitool* (which can generate different types of gear and device tags).

WEAKNESS TAG QUESTIONS

Each themebook includes four weakness tag questions. You must **choose one question to answer**. The answer becomes a weakness tag in the theme.

Weakness tags must always be something that gets in the way of your character's actions. Possessing (and controlling) the strength of ten men is often useful, so this would not be an appropriate weakness tag. If your character is compelled to help others, it may get her in trouble but it does not impede her actions – it spurs her into action. Therefore, this would not be a good description to use as a weakness tag (but it might be a good Identity).

To clarify or fine tune a weakness tag, ask:

? WHAT ACTIONS WOULD THIS WEAKNESS TAG IMPEDE?

Answering this question helps define what exactly is limiting in a weakness tag and how the player expects to use it during the game (which should be clear to the MC as well, see **Agreeing on Interpretation**, page 192). As with power tags, answering this question may also bring the player to rethink and rephrase their tag.

Weakness tags can represent many things, for example:

Apt catchphrases: *just a cog in the machine, don't blow a fuse, takes two to tango*

Background: *sheltered upbringing, from outside the Megacity, awkward nerd*

Denied privileges: *lost citizenship, targeted by the police, damaged street cred*

Flaws in methods: *exposed after mean right hook, sloppy technique, can be traced*

Gear or tech weaknesses: *choppy reception, fuel guzzler, limited range*

Impeding personality traits: *nervous, suspicious-looking, wallflower, overly regimented*

Impeding qualities: *lazy bastard, highly visible, annoying smirk*

Lack of knowledge: *not streetwise, outdated intel, poor manners*

Limitations: *overworked joints, damaged hearing, slow on the uptake*

Obsessions and compulsions: *street drug addiction, freezes under stress, clean kills only*

Rivals and dependents: *rival street gang, corporate nemesis, family obligations*

Source power limitations: *weaker in the dark, requires magical components, physically draining*

Source power side effects: *callous mindset, horrific transformation, eyes like glowing embers*

While your weaknesses often get in your way, they also help you grow (see **Upgrades**, page 133). To achieve a good balance between short-term success and long-term character growth, make sure you choose weakness tags that are not too specific or too broad, such as those in the examples above.

MOTIVATIONS

Each themebook contains pointers on how to create a motivation that fits it as well as some examples of motivations. Read these to help you phrase the motivation for the theme.

CHOOSING IDENTITIES

An Identity is a statement that your character strongly believes in and that drives them to take action. Identities represent your character's ordinary persona: who she thinks she is, what she knows about herself, and the values she believes in. Only Self themes have an Identity.

Your character's Identities are her center of gravity. They represent her deepest beliefs or most dominant convictions, those around which everything else revolves and before which all other aspects of life bow. An Identity could be:

- A conviction about yourself or your life, such as "I don't need anyone else!"
- A promise, oath, or commitment, such as "I will find the cure, whatever the cost."
- A preconception or prejudice, such as "Rich people can't be trusted."
- A restriction, limitation, or red line, such as "If you don't have the money, I can't help you out."
- A greater wish, hope, or dream, such as "The new community center will bring light to the slums."
- A strong feeling or emotional baggage, such as "I can never love again."
- A belief about the world in general, such as "Everything is better when you put on a smile."

An Identity is always an earnest and sincere statement that the character takes seriously (even if the players and MC are entertained by it). Your character does not have to be vehement about what she believes, only that internally, in her head, this statement is very strong.

An Identity should always be directly or indirectly about the character and how she believes she must act or not act, in a manner that is relevant to its theme. It is never an unrelated sentence such as “The grass is green,” unless that has a specific meaning for the character which the player can explain.

Identities do not necessarily have to revolve around mundane things; your character can have an Identity about obtaining Sources or fighting monsters. However, such an Identity should be associated with a Self theme that represents this activity, for example Monster Hunter [Expertise].

To come up with an interesting Identity, ask:

? WHAT DOES YOUR CHARACTER THINK OR FEEL ABOUT THIS ASPECT OF HER LIFE, OR BECAUSE OF IT?

Each Self theme has its own Identity, separate from others, because each aspect of the character’s Self establishes a different part of her humanity.

Acting in contradiction to an Identity too many times will make its theme decay and force your character to replace it. Everything described in that theme will then become lost, unavailable, or less important; it will receive little to no airtime from now on. Each Identity should therefore be directly or indirectly related to what is described in the theme so that breaking this Identity by acting against it can somehow be tied to losing or abandoning the abilities, qualities, knowledge, relationships, or possessions associated with the theme.

CHOOSING RITUALS

A Ritual is a supernatural requirement that your character must fulfill. During the game, your character will be driven to keep this requirement fulfilled or risk losing access to the powers granted by her Sources. Only Mythos themes have Rituals; they represent your Mythos’ legendary demands of you, driving you to keep engaging in strange, often risky behavior to stay connected to the supernatural.

A Ritual comes from your Mythos, but it’s tied to your personal connection to the Source, personalized to the character. It always begins with “I must”. A Ritual could be:

- An actual occult ritual that must be regularly conducted, such as “I must make a sacrifice under the full moon.”
- The need to acquire certain supernatural energies or occult ingredients to recharge your powers, such as “I must harvest the fear of criminals to feed the spirit of Justice.”

- A requirement to regularly behave in a manner consistent with the Source’s narrative, such as “I must follow the path of Prometheus and give technology to those without it.”
- A legendary quest or destiny you must strive to fulfill, such as “I must seek the king of this land, destroy his kingdom, and slay him.”
- A role you must play in your relationship with the creature or entity your Source provides, such as “I must train and feed this dragon.”

Mythoi are not sapient, they are stories that want to be manifested through human life. Therefore, all Rituals represent a cosmic law that links the Mythos and your character: if you embody the Mythos’ and resonate with its story while in contact with its Source, you will gain its powers by association.

A ritual is therefore always a real requirement, demand, or task that the Mythos wants the character to fulfill, never something trivial or theoretical. However, every Mythoi has its own narrative and style, and so Sources are known to demand things that may seem impossible, silly, or even cryptic. To come up with an interesting Ritual, you can ask:

? HOW DOES YOUR MYTHOS WANT YOU TO RETELL ITS STORY IN THE WORLD?

For characters with more than one Mythos theme, Rituals can be tied to entirely different Sources, representing the divergent needs of the various powers, or they could represent different ties to a single Mythos and its growing demands.

Forgoing the requirements of the Ritual for too long will make the Mythos fade away and force your character to replace the Mythos theme to which this Ritual belongs. The powers described in that theme then become lost, unavailable, or less important; they will receive little to no airtime from now on. Each Ritual should therefore be directly or indirectly related to the powers of the theme so that abandoning the Ritual conditions can somehow be tied to abandoning the associated powers.

CHOOSING ITCHES

An Itch is a driving need your character develops due to having access to a specific futuristic technology. For some, it’s born from the realization that the device in their hands grants them so much power, it’ll be crazy *not* to use it, and they find themselves heading beyond what others would consider healthy limits. For others, it’s the fear of missing out, anxiety due to lack of progress, or general disconnectedness the character experiences when not engaging

with that tech, when not using it to its fullest. Only Noise themes have Itches; they represent the impact of future tech on the human's psyche.

An Itch describes an obsessive pattern of behavior (due to the tech pressing all of the brain's dopamine buttons), or a hyper version of a basic human urge (due to the psyche's inability to handle immense power). An Itch always begins with a verb, like a directive, and you could add "I feel a need to..." before it. It could be:

- A habitual need to use the tech whenever possible, such as "Explore new VR worlds."
- A directive to accomplish a certain tech-related ambition, such as "Mod myself into bionic godhood."
- A driving desire to achieve mastery with a given piece of technology, such as "Get there fastest, get there first."
- A dependency you've developed on the technology to serve as a comfortable crutch, such as "Drown out the pain by feeding all my senses with content."
- A desire to use a specific application of a piece of technology you possess, such as "Slay with this nano-edged katana."

An Itch should ideally feel like something you feel in the back of your head, an urge that needs to be satiated at some point sooner than later. It should not be a casual desire, but something that feels visceral: the need to do more, to experience more, to achieve the most.

To come up with an interesting Itch, you can ask:

? WHAT DOES THIS TECHNOLOGY URGE ME TO DO?

An Itch pushes you to be something more than human. These technologies are so advanced that the use of them will change you. It could mean thinking, existing, living, or dying in a way unlike any human has before. If you follow an Itch all the way, it would eventually lead you beyond the boundaries of what others consider normal, until you no longer recognize a need for companionship, sustenance, self-identity, or following social norms and morals.

Each Itch reflects only its own Noise theme. A character who has several Noise themes therefore has several different Itches, which might push her in different directions, all of them leading her away from baseline human norms. You can do this amazing thing. So why shouldn't you? Why not do it *all the time*? And even more, even better? Use the device. And this one also. See where it leads. Your life and mind will change, as you become something else, something *more*.

Resisting an Itch for too long will make its Noise theme break and force your character to replace it. The capabilities described in that theme then become lost, unavailable, or less important; they will receive little to no airtime from now on. Unlike with Self and Mythos themes, each Itch is already directly related to the capabilities granted by its theme. Therefore, resisting the Itch conditions is the same as the character willingly abandoning the associated technology.

CREW RELATIONSHIP SUGGESTIONS

If you're playing with a crew, you can have one relationship tag with each other crew member that describes how you feel about them, what they are to you, or what you are to them. Each themebook has suggestions on how to connect between the theme and one crew member, followed by a suggestion for a relationship tag. You can also create your own relationship tags based on your themes or completely unrelated to them.

List the names of your crew members (excluding your own PC) on your Character Card and put the relationship tag you pick out for each one of them next to their name, after confirming with that character's player that this relationship status works for them.

STEP 4: CHOOSE LOADOUT

Your loadout theme (see **Loadout**, page 114) starts out with three power tags and one weakness tag. Choose items from the **Street Catalog** (page 252) and record their tags on the loadout theme card. The power tags may represent three different items, one item with multiple features, or anything in between. One of the items must have a weakness tag.

Choose items that will complement your abilities well and provide options that you would otherwise not have. A concealed gun can be useful for a combat-oriented PC heading into a formal event, while for a non-combatant PC it provides an option to protect themselves which they might not have had without the gun. Conversely, social tools like the right clothing for a certain milieu can boost a socialite's impact or keep an awkward character relevant.